



Individual Teaching Assistant Report Fall 2025 for ECE 479K - COMPILERS (18950) (Matthew Barondeau)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **22**

Responses Received: **10**

Response Ratio: **45.5 %**

Subject Details

merged_subject_id

merged_subject_display_name

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Friday, January 16, 2026**

Teaching Assistant Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The TA was available to help me as needed.	80.0%	20.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10	4.80
I felt the TA was approachable.	80.0%	20.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10	4.80
The TA explained course concepts, subject matter, or other course-related topics in a way that helped me learn.	70.0%	30.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10	4.70
The TA was able to address most of my questions related to the course concepts, subject -matter, or topics.	88.9%	11.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	9	4.89
The TA communicated course content and subject matter with accuracy.	80.0%	20.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10	4.80
The TA communicated course expectations and instructions clearly.	80.0%	10.0%	10.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10	4.70
The TA appeared engaged throughout the course experience.	90.0%	10.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10	4.90

Comment Questions

Identify aspects of your interactions with your teaching assistant that were most effective in helping your learning.

Comment
Lab Checkouts
office hours, discussion sections.
Matthew felt quite approachable, especially in office hours. Further, I enjoyed the review session given after one of the guest lectures before exam 2. Also, the cookies were always delicious :D
Matthew was really chill during checkouts and even if I got some of the questions wrong, he would try to guide me to the correct answer without putting me down.
Matthew's always approachable, and he answers questions directly.
Matthew often gave us helpful information, such as how and what to study for the exams/figure out difficult aspects of the labs.
TA was super understanding when students needed more time on a lab. During lab checkouts they would provide answers to questions I didn't know which helped me correct my understanding and learn.
He was always easily available via email and answered promptly
Matthew was always helpful and approachable for labs and otherwise.

What is one thing the teaching assistant could do differently to help improve future students' learning in this course?

Comment
N/A
N/A
More structured recitations over specific parts of the lab or LLVM API might have been helpful.
I wish more work was put into making lab docs comprehensive and explain what was needed in each lab better.
Maybe some class notes for review
Office hours later in the week, as often I encountered the most difficult parts of the labs later in the week after completing most of the code.
n/a
Maybe put the recitation sessions on the schedule next time so I can attend them without conflict

Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.